

CV & Resume Types Worldwide in Tech

How resume and CV conventions differ by region and which format tech job seekers should use where

"CV" and "resume" mean different things depending on where you're applying and in tech, the expected format can vary even more, since global remote hiring, GitHub portfolios, and startup culture have created new hybrid formats alongside traditional country-specific ones. Sending the wrong style can signal you haven't done your homework, so it's worth matching local convention (or company culture) before you apply.

1. Regional Overview

Region	Term Used	Typical Length	Photo	Personal Details Shown
USA / Canada	Resume	1–2 pages	No (avoid discrimination law)	None (no age, marital status, photo)
UK / Ireland	CV	2 pages	Uncommon	Minimal name, contact info only
Germany / DACH	CV (Lebenslauf)	1–2 pages	Common/expected/Optional	DOB, nationality, sometimes marital status
Rest of EU (Europass)	CV	1–2 pages	Optional	Varies by country; Europass allows optional fields
Australia / NZ	CV or Resume	2–3 pages	No	None
India / South Africa	CV or Resume (used interchangeably)	1–2 pages	Sometimes (India, private sector)	Sometimes DOB, marital status in India
Japan	Rirekisho + Shokumukeirekisho (2 docs)	1 page each, fixed JIS format	Mandatory (3x4cm)	DOB, gender, nationality, photo, commute time
Middle East / Gulf	CV	1–2 pages	Often expected	Nationality, sometimes religion/visa status

Rule of thumb: in the US/Canada, "CV" means an academic document never send a long CV for a standard tech role there. Everywhere else, "CV" is usually just the local word for what Americans call a resume.

2. Tech-Specific CV/Resume Formats

Format	What It Is & When To Use It
US-Style Tech Resume	One page (two max for 10+ years experience), reverse-chronological, quantified achievements ("reduced latency by 40%"), no photo/personal data. Standard for US/Canada tech roles and often accepted globally by international/remote-first companies.
Europass CV	EU-standardized template with optional fields for photo, languages (using the CEFR scale), and skills matrix. Common for applying within the EU, especially for entry-level, public-sector, or cross-border EU roles.

German-Style CV (Lebenslauf)	Strict reverse-chronological table format, professional photo in the top corner, includes DOB/place of birth/nationality. Usually paired with a separate one-page Anschreiben (cover letter). Expected by most German companies, including tech.
Academic CV	Long-form (can run 5–20+ pages), used for research, PhD, postdoc, and professor-track roles anywhere in the world including research-heavy tech roles (e.g., AI research labs). Includes publications, grants, conference talks, teaching experience.
Portfolio / GitHub-First Resume	A short resume (often 1 page) that leans on links rather than text GitHub profile, deployed projects, LeetCode/Kaggle stats, personal site. Increasingly common for software engineering and data science roles worldwide, especially at startups.
Japan's Rirekisho + Shokumukeirekisho	Two-document system: the Rirekisho is a fixed-format personal/education history form (JIS standard); the Shokumukeirekisho is a flexible career-history document similar to a Western resume. Required for most Japan-based roles, including at many tech companies, though some multinational/foreign-friendly firms accept a Western-style CV instead.
LinkedIn-Native Profile	Not a document at all, but functionally treated as a CV by many recruiters, especially for tech sourcing/inbound recruiting globally. Increasingly the first artifact reviewed before a formal resume is requested.

3. Key Differences to Watch For

Photo: expected/common in Germany, Japan, and much of the Middle East and Asia; actively discouraged in the US, Canada, UK, and Australia due to anti-discrimination norms.

Personal details (date of birth, marital status, nationality): standard on German, Japanese, and many Asian/Middle Eastern CVs; omitted entirely on US, Canadian, UK, and Australian resumes.

Length: US tech resumes stay to 1 page (2 for senior candidates); German and UK CVs run 1–2 pages; academic CVs can run far longer with no fixed limit.

Chronology: Japan's rirekisho and most European CVs are strictly reverse-chronological with no gaps hidden; US resumes are more flexible and can be organized by skill or project relevance.

Language & tone: US resumes favor confident, results-driven language ("increased throughput by 3x"); German CVs are more neutral and factual; Japanese documents follow a fixed, formal tone with little room for self-promotion.

4. Official Resources & Templates

Resource	What It Offers
Europass CV Builder	Official EU CV builder and template, free to use
Make it in Germany	Official German government guide to German-style CVs & cover letters
JIS Rirekisho Template (via JETRO/METI-linked guides)	Japanese trade organization background on standard hiring documents
LinkedIn	Global professional profile, often reviewed before a resume is requested
GitHub	Portfolio evidence for software engineering / data roles worldwide

This guide is for general orientation only. Hiring norms vary by company (especially at international/remote-first tech firms) and change over time when in doubt, check the specific job posting or company careers page for their preferred format.